
It's All Over the Internet and Even SNL. Bill Clinton and Donald Trump Sure Don't Want You Talking About It.

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I never thought I'd be nostalgic for that period in the first Donald Trump administration when everyone decided it was the height of humor [to joke about Trump's "love affair" with Vladimir Putin](#). It was hacky and homophobic, and yet it was also more innocent than the current joke of the moment, which involves the infinitely more disturbing image of Trump performing fellatio on former President Bill Clinton.

Yes, this is where we've arrived. The latest intrusive thought comes courtesy of last week's release of [20,000 previously sealed pages of documents from the estate of Jeffrey Epstein](#), the financier, convicted sex offender, and onetime friend of Trump. Among the many notable things in the files, the masses seized on [one particular email thread](#) between Epstein and his brother, Mark Epstein, from 2018: After Jeffrey mentioned that he was with Trump ally Steve Bannon, Mark responded by telling his brother to ask Bannon "if Putin has the photos of Trump blowing Bubba."

First off, who's "Bubba"? One doesn't hear it as much these days, so it makes sense that some didn't recognize it as a fairly ubiquitous nickname for Clinton during his presidency. With that matter settled, the email quickly became a widespread joke, inspiring [edits on TikTok set to Sabrina Carpenter songs](#), [dirty photoshopped Time magazine covers](#), and even a [reference on Saturday Night Live this weekend](#).

Well, most people were treating it as a joke: I also came across a certain number of [posts online](#) that appeared to be written by people who seemed convinced that this email proves that this sex act truly happened, that photographic evidence of it exists, and that it's in Putin's possession as we *speak*. I would like to confidently declare that these posts must be either fake or trolling because no one *really* thinks that, but upon reflection, I can totally believe that some people's reading comprehension and media literacy is that poor.

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In any case, maybe most people would have moved on after a few days of this, but over the weekend, Mark Epstein himself decided to weigh in. He [released a statement](#) asserting that the “Bubba” he mentioned in the emails is “not, in any way, a reference to former President Bill Clinton.” It was a curious clarification to make. Wouldn’t it make more sense to explain that the whole thing was a joke, rather than imply that it simply concerned a different “Bubba”? Did Clinton himself push for Mark Epstein to make this statement? Whatever the case, it wasn’t very convincing, except to the brain rot crowd: They’re now speculating that “Bubba” was Ghislaine Maxwell’s horse, or an oil executive—sure, why not?

Now that Mark Epstein’s non-denial left the door open for the general populace to keep laughing at the idea of Trump servicing Clinton, how many more days or weeks of blow job talk must we endure? Many more, I’m sure, to say nothing of what we’ll find after the House votes to force the Justice Department to release all the Epstein files on Tuesday, an outcome Trump claims he supports. I know this is a schoolmarm-ish stance to take, but I’m over it. Remember a few years ago, when everyone thought it was such a gas that [Nancy Reagan was once referred to as Hollywood’s “blow job queen”](#)? As if there aren’t tons of better reasons to go after these people, and as if we didn’t spend a better part of the ’90s slut-shaming someone for giving a blow job to Bill Clinton. Shouldn’t we have a different tack all these years later? This was the sort of thing that Jeffrey Epstein and his brother thought was funny, and that should be reason enough to reconsider.

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